

## 1.2 Assessment information

- This unit assesses speaking skills.
- First assessment: June 2017.
- The assessment is 8-10 minutes (plus 15 minutes' preparation time).
- The assessment is out of 40 marks.
- The assessment consists of two sections with four questions in Section A and a discussion in Section B.
- All questions are set in **one** of the four general topic areas (GTAs).
- The use of dictionaries is not permitted.
- Students must inform the teacher/examiner which **two** GTAs they have chosen before the assessment via an *Oral topic form* (OR1) (which can be found in *Appendix 7: Oral assessment forms*). One copy of the form must be given to the teacher/examiner no more than three weeks in advance of the examination.
- Assessment time should be divided equally between Sections A and B. However, if students complete the answers to the questions in Section A in less than four minutes, the teacher/examiner should ensure that the discussion in Section B is extended, in order that the total assessment time is at least eight minutes, however, without exceeding 10 minutes. Responses that go over ten minutes will not be assessed.
- Assessments will be conducted by teachers/examiners in one of two prescribed assessment windows; either in November/December or in April/May in any single year. Dates for the assessment period will be confirmed at the start of each academic year. The assessment period will not always be continuous or be the same period each year, for example it will need to accommodate the Easter break, which may change from year to year. Please note that the oral examinations must be undertaken on one day only unless your centre has a large cohort, in which case it is possible to undertake them on consecutive days. (A typical maximum would be 15 students per teacher per day.)
- Complete, unedited recordings of all assessments must be submitted to Pearson for external marking. Please see the *Administrative support guide* for more information.
- All assessments will be marked against assessment criteria that can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel International A Level in Spanish Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* documents and in this specification.
- Students are only permitted to complete this assessment once per session.
- Students must sign the *Student speaking authentication sheet (CAS)* (which can be found in *Appendix 7: Oral assessment forms*) on completion of the assessment.
- Teacher/examiners must complete the *CAS form* and return it to Pearson along with the examination recordings and the completed *OR1 forms*.